You’d need considerable time and know-how to build a comparable relational database environment based on virtual machines, so we recommend using Amazon RDS for relational databases whenever possible to decrease operational costs and improve quality. That’s why we won’t cover hosting your own relational database on VMs in this book. Instead, we’ll introduce Amazon RDS in detail.

In this chapter, you’ll launch a MySQL database with the help of Amazon RDS. Chapter 2 introduced a WordPress setup like the one shown in figure 10.1 and described next; you’ll use this example in this chapter, focusing on the database part:

1. The user sends an HTTP request to the load balancer.
2. The load balancer distributes the incoming request to a fleet of virtual machines.
3. Each virtual machine runs a web server, which connects to a MySQL database as well as a network filesystem.